

spectrum, where people are already employed. Here we have platforms by sector that we set up in partnership with industry. One example is the IT industry, where we do FutureSkills Prime, where the government contributes money, the industry contributes coursework, curriculum and money, and allows retraining and lateral and upward movement of reskilling and upskilling within the technology sector.

We have committed ₹460 crore of capital to the FutureSkills Prime programme. So, you have two layers of skilling—One is broad skilling—the

ments, foreign consumers, overseas consumers. We are strapped by the fact that while we have many IT engineers, we are strapped back in particular niches, where the demand is far in excess of supply, and that is where you're getting wage inflation—companies have gone abroad or hired engineers, etc. So, those kinds of issues will be dealt with by the FutureSkills Prime platform.



This programme was launched in 2018 and the target is that in five years, 1.4 million

talent and skill, is that the industry itself did not anticipate this kind of massive growth and massive demand for talent. The government has no role in anticipating the talent that industry requires. We can be enablers; we can be facilitators. We can even provide money and investments for platforms to be created. But at the end of the day, it is the technology companies that have to work on their skill and talent strategic plan.

That was the whole idea of a partnership with the industry. And I have publicly said this to Nasscom—this problem has



If someone lacks funds for upskilling and reskilling, how can they look at upskilling/reskilling and multiskilling?

Right now, most of the skilling programmes are free. Over the last five years, all of the basic skilling programmes are almost free. The government is spending ₹4,000-5,000 crore a year on PMKVY and other skilling-related programmes. It is ITIs that charge a low fee, but even there, state governments provide scholarships to those who are economically weak and other communities that require sup-

WE ARE CREATING SKILLING PLANS FOR EACH OF THE 700 DISTRICTS... A MAHATMA GANDHI NATIONAL FELLOW WILL WORK WITH THE LOCAL DISTRICT COLLECTOR IN SHAPING SKILLS ACCORDING TO LOCAL REQUIREMENTS

employees would be trained. What has been the progress like?

There are two things. The government's role in FutureSkills is about providing capital and building the platform. On this, I have publicly spoken to the industry as well. I think part of the blame for the problems that the industry finds itself in today, which is the shortage of

been created maybe accidentally, maybe because these are circumstances that you did not anticipate... But I think a little bit of slackness on the part of the industry is one of the reasons for what we are seeing today—wage inflation, shortage of talent in certain segments... [such as] emerging technology segments like AI and other areas.

port. But broadly in this Skill India ecosystem, the skilling is almost to a large extent free and the training partners in the training centres are compensated by the government for every skilling programme every student takes.

Your question relates to an existing participant in the industry, who wants to be upskilled and reskilled because there's

80 | blue-collar community of people who are moving from schools to ITIs and schools to basic skilling and moving up that way. Then you have within the industry the skilling model... like we have for technology services, tomorrow we will start something, for example, for semiconductors; we may have it for electronics manufacturing. We may have the same model, which is industry-government partnership, to allow talent within a sector to be better deployed, to be better skilled. One of the things that everybody has noticed [is that] in the last 18 months as the world's digitisation needs galloped, it presented to the Indian industry more and more opportunities for work—projects for servicing, foreign enterprises, foreign govern-